GenFlows — SEO & AEO Audit + Implementation Plan

Why we're not ranking yet, and the sequenced plan to fix it — content, technical SEO & web-dev workstreams.

Date: 21 July 2026 · **Property:** www.genflows.com (HubSpot CMS, portal 49399880) · **Scope:** 62 published posts + site signals

Sources: HubSpot CMS API (live), live crawl of genflows.com, sitemap.xml, robots.txt. **Not yet available:** Google Search Console (OAuth not authorized — all query/position analysis pending).

62	18 days	18	0	52
PUBLISHED POSTS	MEDIAN POST AGE	MISSING FROM SITEMAP	FAQ SCHEMA BLOCKS	OVER-LENGTH TITLES

0 · Executive summary — the honest verdict

> **Nothing is fundamentally broken. The single biggest reason we're not ranking is that the content is brand new on a low-authority domain.** 50 of 62 posts are under 30 days old (median **18 days**). New pages on a young domain routinely take **3–6 months** to rank for competitive terms; AI answer engines lag further still. We are in the normal "waiting" window — not a penalty.

That said, the audit surfaced **real, fixable problems slowing us down** and a set of **AEO (AI-search) opportunities we're leaving entirely on the table**:

1. **18 of 62 posts — every high-value commercial post from the last 6 batches — are missing from the sitemap.** Google may not know they exist yet.
2. **Zero FAQ schema**, despite every post having a 6-question FAQ section. Biggest single AI-search / rich-result miss.
3. **No off-page authority (backlinks)** — the real reason competitive terms won't move regardless of on-page quality.
4. **Secondary issues:** one post stuck on a 1970 publish date; sitemap not declared in robots.txt; 58/62 posts have no featured image; 52/62 title tags too long.
5. **GSC still not connected** — we're blind on impressions/positions and "striking distance" wins.

The content itself is strong and unusually AEO-ready (long-form, answer-first TL;DRs, comparison tables, cited sources, clean H-structure). **The gap is discovery, authority, and machine-readable markup — not quality.**

1 · Why we're not ranking — root causes (ranked)

1.1 Content age & ranking latency — biggest factor

Age bucket	0–14 days	15–30 days	31–60 days	60 days+
Posts	30	20	11	1

Median age **18 days**. Google needs time to crawl, index, gather engagement signals and assess trust — typically a quarter+ on a domain without established authority. Expected and self-resolving with time + the fixes below.

1.2 Domain authority & backlinks — the real competitive lever

We target commercial, high-competition keywords ("best cold email software", "clay pricing", "cold email cost", "best CRM for outbound") held by aged, heavily-linked incumbents (growthtoday.co, RevPartners, vendor domains). On-page quality alone does not beat that — **links do**. genflows.com is a young domain with very few referring domains. (Exact count needs GSC "Links" or Ahrefs/Semrush — flagged, not yet measured.)

1.3 Discovery gap — 18 posts missing from the sitemap

Our newest, most valuable posts aren't in `/sitemap.xml` (§2.1). If Google can't find a URL, it can't rank it — compounding 1.1 on exactly the pages we most want ranking.

1.4 We can't optimize what we can't measure (GSC)

Without Search Console we have no visibility into impressions, average position, or "striking-distance" queries (positions 5–20, where small edits produce fast wins). Connecting GSC is a prerequisite, not a nice-to-have.

2 · Technical SEO findings (measured today)

Finding	Sev.	Detail & fix
Sitemap coverage gap	High	44/62 posts present; 18 missing (all batches 9–14 — our best commercial content). Force HubSpot sitemap regen, resubmit in GSC, Request Indexing for the 18.
Sitemap not in robots.txt	Med	robots.txt has only Disallow rules — no `Sitemap:` line. Add `Sitemap: https://www.genflows.com/sitemap.xml`.
Post frozen at 1970-01-01	Med	`linkedin-outreach-for-agencies-book-sales-calls-2025` has epoch-0 publishDate; renders a broken date. PATCH publishDate via API.
Canonical / meta-robots / og:type / H1 / long-form	OK	Self-referencing canonicals, index,follow, og:type=article, single H1, clean H2 tree, ~3k words. Correct — leave alone.

The 18 missing URLs: ai-cold-email-personalization-2026 · best-ai-sdr-tools-2026-pricing-comparison · best-crm-b2b-outbound-… · best-email-verification-tools-2026 · best-email-warmup-… · best-linkedin-automation-tools-… · cold-email-ab-testing-guide-2026 · cold-email-cost-per-meeting-budget-2026 · cold-email-deliverability-monitoring-2026 · cold-email-spf-dkim-dmarc-setup-2026 · crm-data-hygiene-outbound-teams-2026 · how-to-build-b2b-cold-email-list-2026 · how-to-handle-cold-email-replies-… · lead-routing-speed-to-lead-2026 · linkedin-message-templates-… · linkedin-sales-navigator-… · n8n-vs-make-vs-zapier-… · revops-manager-job-description-salary-2026.

3 · On-page SEO findings

Issue	Count	Impact	Fix
Title tag > 65 chars	52 / 62	SERP truncation → lower CTR	Trim to ≤60 chars, keyword first
No featured image (og:image empty)	58 / 62	Weak social/AI cards, no image results	Add featured images (needs `files` scope on token)
Meta description < 70 chars	10 / 62	Under-uses SERP space	Expand to 140–160 chars
No topic tags	62 / 62	No native cluster grouping	Tag into 5 clusters
Missing meta description	0 / 62	—	Already clean ✓
Internal linking	strong	Real strength	Add links to service/money pages, not just `/`

4 · AEO / AI-search readiness — the biggest opportunity

AEO = getting cited by ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews, Claude. Our content is structurally well-suited; we're missing the markup that makes extraction trivial.

4.1 No FAQPage schema — the #1 AEO miss

Every post has a 6-Q&A FAQ section, but **none are marked up as `FAQPage`** (confirmed on 3 sampled posts). FAQ schema drives Google FAQ rich results & People-Also-Ask, and lets AI engines lift our Q&As verbatim as cited answers. **High impact, low effort — the Q&As already exist.** (Caveat: HubSpot may strip `<script>` from post body; reliable path is a theme/template FAQ module or a post-level HTML-injection field — verify before rollout.)

4.2 What already helps AEO

- Answer-first **TL;DR boxes** — ideal for AI extraction.
- **Comparison tables** (pricing/tools/thresholds) — AI engines favour structured comparisons.
- **Cited sources & dates** — supports trust / E-E-A-T.
- Baseline **BlogPosting / Organization / Person / BreadcrumbList** JSON-LD present.

4.3 AEO gaps beyond FAQ schema

- **Author E-E-A-T:** add `author` with real bio + link to author page (`/consultancy/wouter` exists — wire into schema + bylines).
- **Entity clarity:** add `Organization sameAs` (LinkedIn, Clay/Smartlead partner badges we already display).
- **Off-site citations:** AI engines weight Reddit / LinkedIn / G2 / comparison-site mentions. Zero presence = zero AI citations regardless of on-site quality.
- **Publish `llms.txt`** — emerging convention some AI crawlers read.

5 · Content-strategy findings

- **Breadth is excellent** — 62 posts across 5 clusters (Clay/GTM, Cold Email, Outbound, RevOps, Growth), each mapped to a service line. A real asset once authority arrives.
- **Cannibalization watch** — many close cold-email posts (deliverability ×4, LinkedIn ×5). Cross-linked to disambiguate; confirm with GSC that two posts aren't competing for one query.
- **No explicit pillar pages** — designate one pillar per cluster with hub-and-spoke linking to concentrate authority.
- **No conversion path** — posts end with a CTA to `/` ; build dedicated service landing pages per cluster.

6 · Blocked until Google Search Console is connected

The OAuth token was never minted (`research/.gsc_token.json` absent). Run `python3 research/gsc_connect.py` and authorize as bivek@genflowsagency.com. This unlocks:

- **Striking-distance report** — queries ranking 5–20; fastest wins.
- **CTR gaps** — high-impression/low-click pages → retitle (ties to the 52 long titles).
- **Query-to-page mapping** — confirm targets, detect cannibalization.
- **Indexation truth** — which of the 18 missing posts Google has actually indexed.
- **Backlink reality** — quantifies §1.2.

Implementation Plan

Three parallel workstreams. Owner key: **Me (Claude)** = automatable now with current access · **You** = credential/settings · **Dev** = website developer (theme/template).

A · Technical SEO workstream

#	Action	Owner	Impact	When
P0	Connect GSC (run `gsc_connect.py`, authorize)	You	High	This week
P0	Regenerate sitemap; resubmit in GSC; Request Indexing for the 18 missing posts	You + Me	High	This week
P0	Add `Sitemap:` line to robots.txt	Dev / You	Med	This week
P0	Fix the 1970 publishDate (API PATCH)	Me	Med	This week
P1	Trim 52 title tags to ≤60 chars, keyword-first (bulk via API)	Me	Med (CTR)	Wk 2
P1	Striking-distance optimization from GSC data	Me	High	Wk 2–4
P1	Grant HubSpot token the `files` scope; add featured images to 58 posts	You + Me	Med	Wk 2–4
P2	Expand 10 short meta descriptions; add topic tags for 5 clusters	Me	Low	Wk 4+

B · Website-developer workstream (theme / template)

These need theme-level access the CMS API can't reach — hand this list to the web developer.

#	Task	Why	Priority
1	**FAQPage JSON-LD module** in the blog-post template — auto-emit `FAQPage` schema from each post's FAQ section (or a repeatable FAQ field)	#1 AEO win; FAQ rich results + AI citations	P0
2	**Article/author schema** — add `author` (bio, sameAs, link to `/consultancy/wouter`) and `Organization sameAs` (LinkedIn + partner profiles) to post schema	E-E-A-T, entity strength for AI	P1
3	**robots.txt** — add the Sitemap directive (if not editable in HubSpot settings)	Crawler/AI discovery	P0
4	**Default OG/featured-image fallback** in the template (branded image when a post has none)	Fixes 58 empty og:image cards immediately	P1
5	**Core Web Vitals pass** — lazy-load images, defer non-critical JS, check LCP/CLS/INP on blog template	Ranking + UX signal	P1
6	**Cluster service/landing pages** (Cold Email, Clay/GTM, RevOps, LinkedIn) as conversion targets for blog CTAs	Turns traffic into pipeline; concentrates authority	P1
7	**Pillar-page hub template** with automated spoke-linking per cluster	Topic-cluster authority model	P2
8	**Publish `/llms.txt`** and ensure AI bots (GPTBot, PerplexityBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended) are allowed in robots.txt	AEO discoverability	P2
9	**Breadcrumb + related-posts module** surfaced on-page (not just schema)	Internal linking + dwell time	P2

C · Content-creation workstream

The engine works (14 batches, 62 posts). Shift emphasis from *breadth* to *authority + conversion + refresh*.

Track	What	Cadence	Owner
New posts	Continue clean-gap batches of 3, but bias toward **lower-competition long-tail** (faster early wins) and **bottom-funnel commercial** (pricing, comparisons, "vs", "cost", "alternatives") that convert	3 / week (unchanged)	Me
Pillar upgrades	Expand one cluster head-post per cluster into a true pillar (2,500–4,000 words) with spoke links; designate the canonical target for each cluster	1 / week	Me

Refresh loop	Once GSC is live: monthly, pull striking-distance + decaying pages and update (freshness date, new sections, tighter intent match)	Monthly	Me + GSC
AEO formatting	Bake FAQPage-ready markup, "quick answer" summaries, and a stats/definition block into every new post so schema is trivial for the dev module to consume	Every post	Me
Off-site / authority	Repurpose top posts into LinkedIn posts, Reddit answers, guest articles, and directory/G2 profiles; pursue partner backlinks (Clay, Smartlead)	Ongoing	You / team
Original data	Publish first-party benchmark data (our real campaign stats) — the deferred P3.01/P3.03 posts — the most link-worthy, most-cited-by-AI asset type	1 / month	You + Me

Expected timeline

Window	What to expect
Weeks 1–4	Indexation fixes + FAQ schema land → more pages indexed, first FAQ rich results / AI citations possible, CTR up on retitled pages.
Months 2–3	Long-tail + low-competition queries start ranking; striking-distance edits (from GSC) produce first page-1 wins.
Months 3–6+	Head terms move **only if** the backlink/authority + original-data work is underway. On-page alone caps out on competitive terms.

Bottom line: the content foundation is strong and unusually AEO-ready. Fix discovery (sitemap), add machine-readable markup (FAQ schema), connect GSC to steer, then invest in authority — that sequence turns 62 good posts into ranking, cited posts.

Prepared from live HubSpot + genflows.com data on 21 July 2026. Backlink/authority claims are reasoned inferences pending GSC/third-party confirmation; all query-level analysis pending GSC authorization. Companion source file: `research/SEO_AEO_AUDIT_2026-07-21.md`.